BSU-IACUC Web Portal User Manual

For Administrative Staff

Benguet State University, Cordillera Center for Animal Research and Development (CCARD)

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I. About this manual

This manual explains how to use the BSU-IACUC portal as administrative staff. It follows the order in which most staff use the system: creating an account, working through the Dashboard, handling payments and endorsements, matching clearances, and then keeping records, site content and accounts up to date.

The portal is run by the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) under CCARD. Reviewers handle the first stage, in which they comment on each protocol and either mark it as reviewed or send it back to the researcher. Administrative staff handle everything after the review: verifying payment, assigning the IPN, uploading the signed scan, endorsing the protocol, matching the released clearance, and confirming the hard copy pickup. Staff also manage records, site content, accounts, audit logs and backups.

Administrative staff can open every protocol, but only reviewers can add comments and return protocols for revision. This manual does not cover reviewer tasks.

II. Before you start

Prepare the following before you create your account.

1. An invitation link from another administrative staff member. Staff accounts cannot be created from the public Register page. Each link works for 48 hours, so ask for a new one if yours has expired.
2. An email address you can open right now. The portal sends a verification link to it and uses it to tell you when something needs your action.
3. A computer, if you can. The portal also works on a tablet or phone, but matching clearances and working through tables are easier on a larger screen.

Staff actions change the status of protocols and the data shown to researchers, so double-check each confirmation window before you proceed. Most actions can be undone while the next step has not happened yet, and every action is recorded in the audit log.

The portal works in any current browser on a computer, tablet or phone.

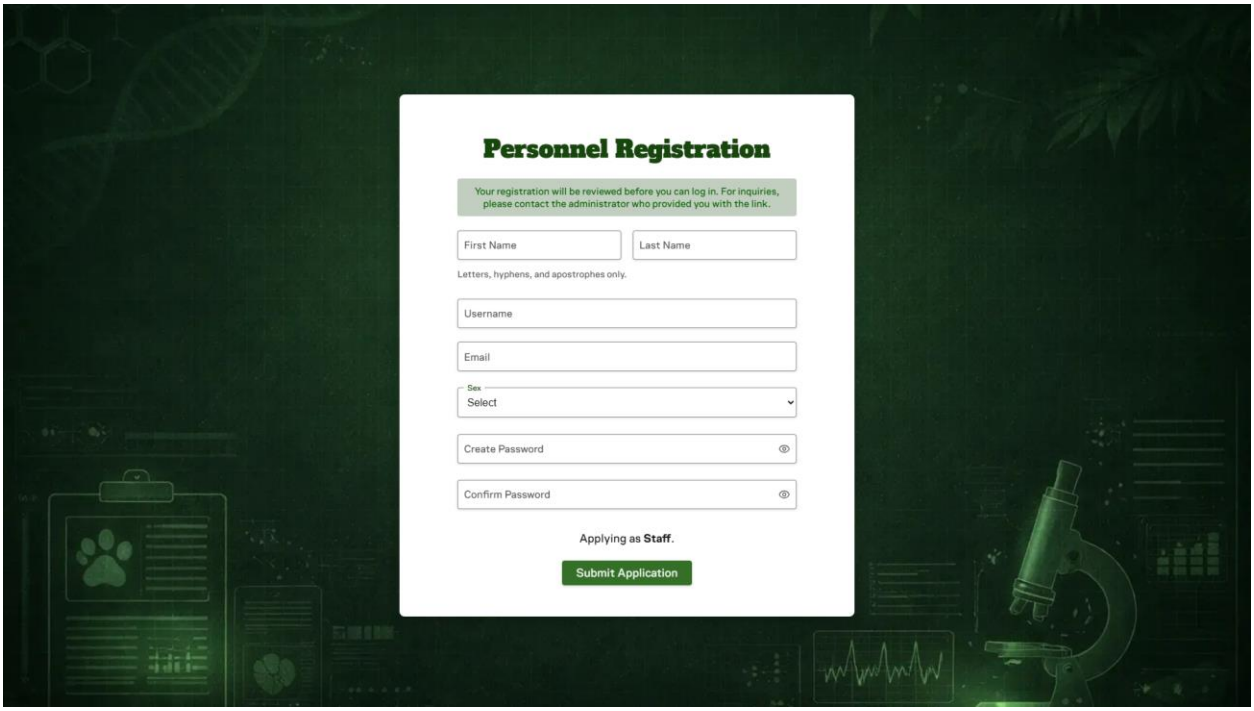
III. Creating an account

1. Open the invitation link you received. The Personnel Registration page opens and shows the role you are applying as. It should say Staff.
2. Fill in the form. Every field is required.

Field	***What to enter***
First name, Last name	Letters, spaces, hyphens and apostrophes only, at least 2 characters each

Username	3 to 50 characters. Letters, numbers, underscores and hyphens only
Email	A valid address you can open
Sex	Male or Female
Create Password	At least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a number and a special character
Confirm Password	Type the same password again

3. Press Submit Application.



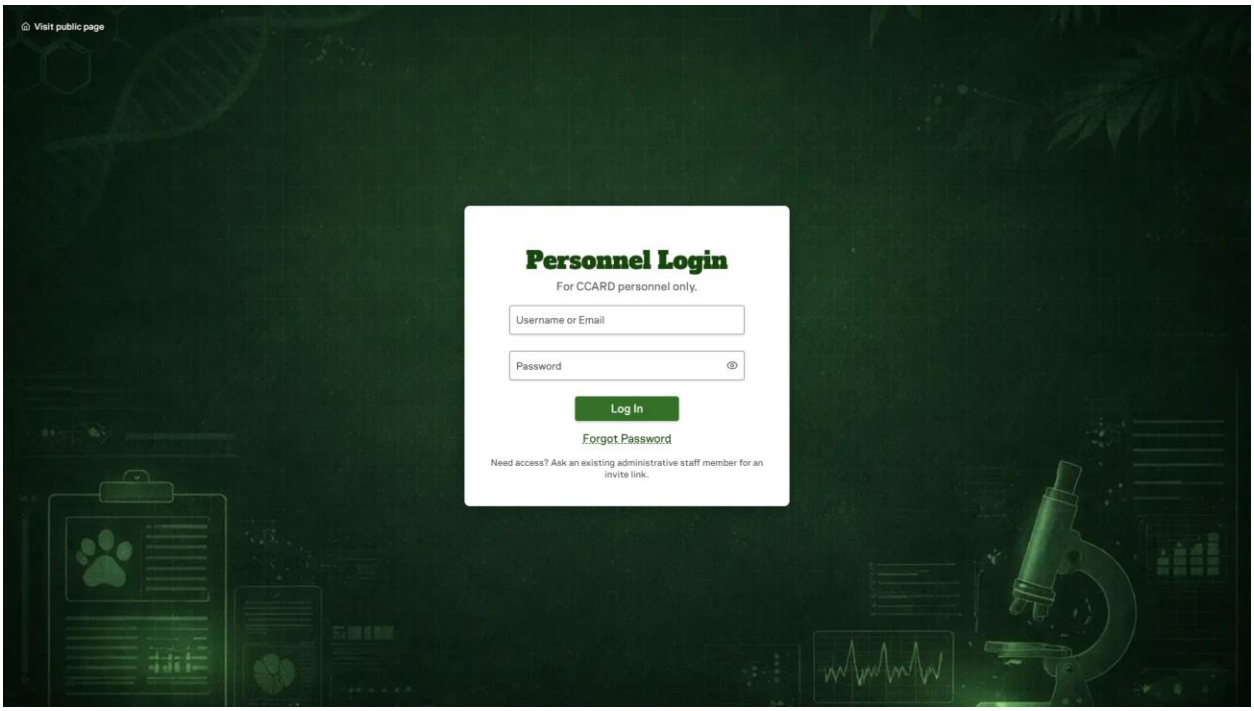
Your account is not active yet. Another administrative staff member must approve your application first (see section XIV), and you will be notified by email once it has been reviewed. You cannot log in until then.

Verifying your email

You can log in before your email is verified, but the portal keeps reminding you until it is done. Press Verify email in My Account to get a verification link, then open the link to confirm the address. On the reminder, press Remind me later to hide it for one hour. If you change your email address later, you will need to verify the new one.

IV. Logging in and out

Open the Personnel Login page. Its address is the portal address followed by /personnel/login (https://iacuc.infinityfree.me/portal/personnel/login). Enter your username or email and your password, then press Log In. After a successful login you land on the Dashboard.



A few things to know:

- If your account has not been approved yet, the portal tells you that it is pending administrative staff approval.
- Five wrong attempts within 15 minutes lock the login for 15 minutes. Wait, then try again.
- If you forget your password, press Forgot Password, enter your email and open the reset link we send. Choose a new password that meets the same rules as above. If the link has expired, request a new one from the same page.
- For your protection, the portal signs you out after 30 minutes without activity. A warning appears about two minutes before this happens. Press the button in the warning to stay signed in.
- Log out from the account menu at the top right when you are using a shared computer.

Inactive accounts

Personnel accounts are deactivated automatically when the owner has not logged in for 6 months. A deactivated account cannot log in, and only administrative staff can reactivate it. If your own account was deactivated, ask another administrative staff member to reactivate it from the Administration page (section XIV).

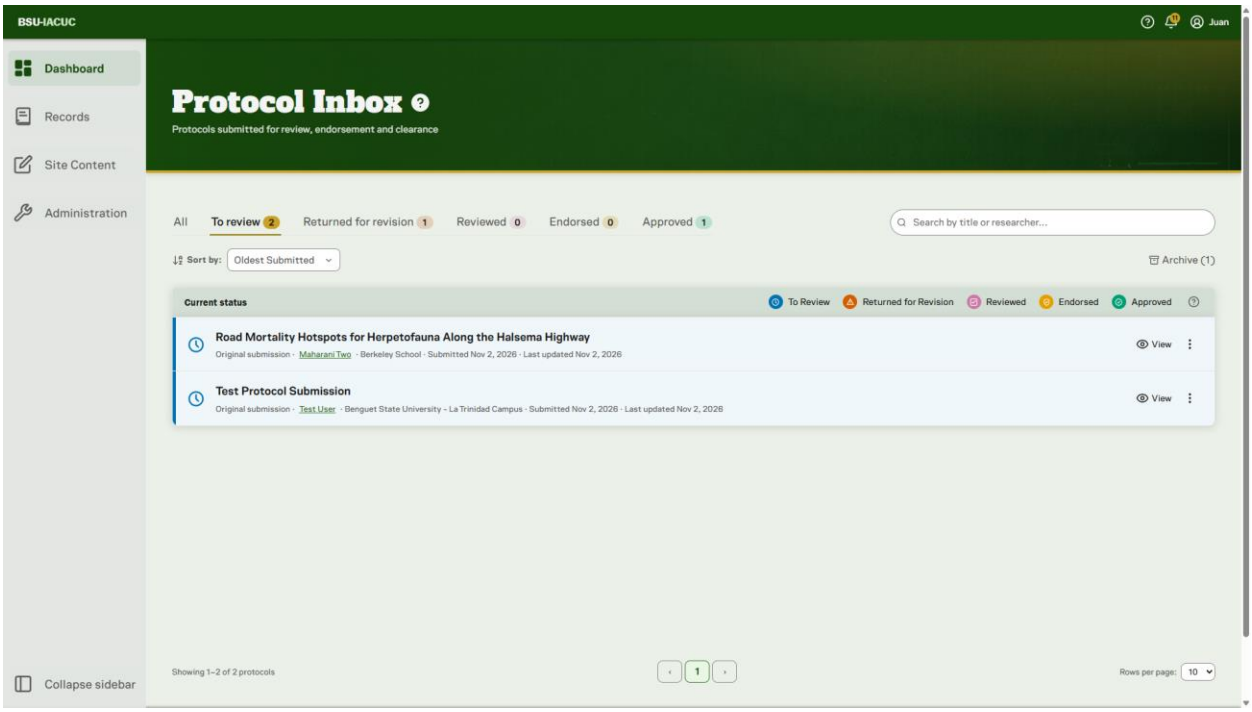
V. Finding your way around

The menu

The icon bar on the left side of the page (the menu button on a phone) has four pages.

Page	*What it is for*
Dashboard	The protocol inbox. This is where you will spend most of your time
Records	The table of all protocol records, with a Statistics tab
Site Content	Announcements, the homepage banner, contact offices and the FAQ
Administration	Audit logs, personnel accounts and backups

Press the Expand sidebar button at the bottom of the bar to show the page names next to the icons.



The top bar

The top bar holds the Guide button, the notification bell, and My Account. A small Offline tag appears beside the logo when your device has lost its connection (see section XV).

Built-in guides

The portal can walk you through itself. The first time you log in, a short tour starts automatically and explains your role. Press the Guide button in the top bar to replay it.

Most pages and tabs also have a small question mark button that opens a tour of that page. Use Next and Back to move through a tour, or press Enter to go forward.

Light and dark theme

Open My Account and choose light, dark or system. System follows your device setting.

Previewing the public site

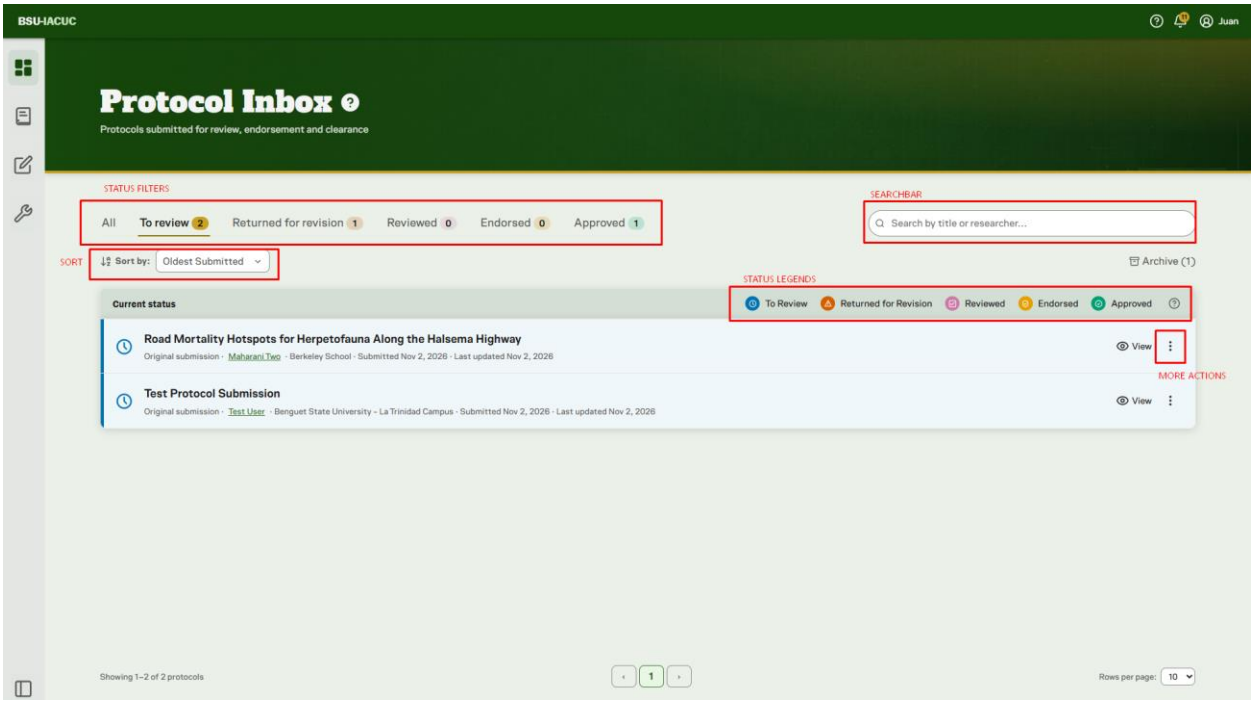
Open My Account and press Preview public site to see the Home, Announcements and Contact Us pages as researchers see them. It opens in a new tab and is marked Preview. Use it to check your changes after editing Site Content.

VI. The Dashboard

The Dashboard lists every protocol submitted to CCARD. The main button on each card is your next task for that protocol.

- Search finds a protocol by its title or by the researcher's name.
- Status filters at the top narrow the list to one status. The number beside each name is how many protocols have that status.
- Sort changes the order: newest or oldest submitted, recently updated, or by title. The default is oldest submitted first.
- The status legend shows the color and icon of each status. Press the question mark at the end of the bar to read what each status means.
- Archive holds approved protocols of researchers whose accounts are inactive. They are kept out of the other tabs and move back to Approved when the researcher reactivates their account.
- Each card is one protocol. It shows the status icon, the title, the submission round, the researcher's name and school, the date submitted and the date last updated.
- Press a researcher's name on a card to see their contact details and the status of their training certificate.
- On the Reviewed tab, a Payment filter narrows the list to Unpaid, Verifying Payment, Payment Rejected or Paid protocols.
- The bar at the bottom lets you move between pages and choose 10, 25 or 50 protocols per page.

The three-dot menu on each card holds the other actions (section XI).



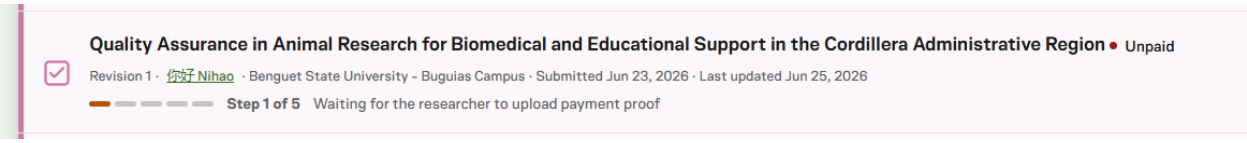
VII. What each status means

Status	*What it means*	*What you do*
To Review	Waiting for a reviewer. If it is the researcher's first submission, their training certificate is also waiting to be verified.	Nothing for the review itself. You may verify the certificate (section X).
Returned for Revision	A reviewer sent the protocol back to the researcher, or the agency returned it after endorsement.	Nothing. Wait for the researcher to resubmit.
Reviewed	A reviewer finished the review. The clearance fee process starts here.	Verify payment, assign the IPN, upload the signed scan and mark as endorsed (section VIII).
Endorsed	You endorsed the protocol to the Department of Agriculture, Regional Field Office, Cordillera Administrative Region (DA-RFO-CAR).	Upload the released clearance, match it to the protocol and mark as approved (section IX).
Approved	The animal research clearance has been issued.	Confirm when the researcher has picked up the hard copy.

The Dashboard calls the first status To Review. Inside the protocol viewer, the same status is called Under Review.

VIII. Endorsing a reviewed protocol

A protocol on the Reviewed tab moves through five steps before it can be endorsed. The main button on each card always shows your next task, and the card shows which step the protocol is on.



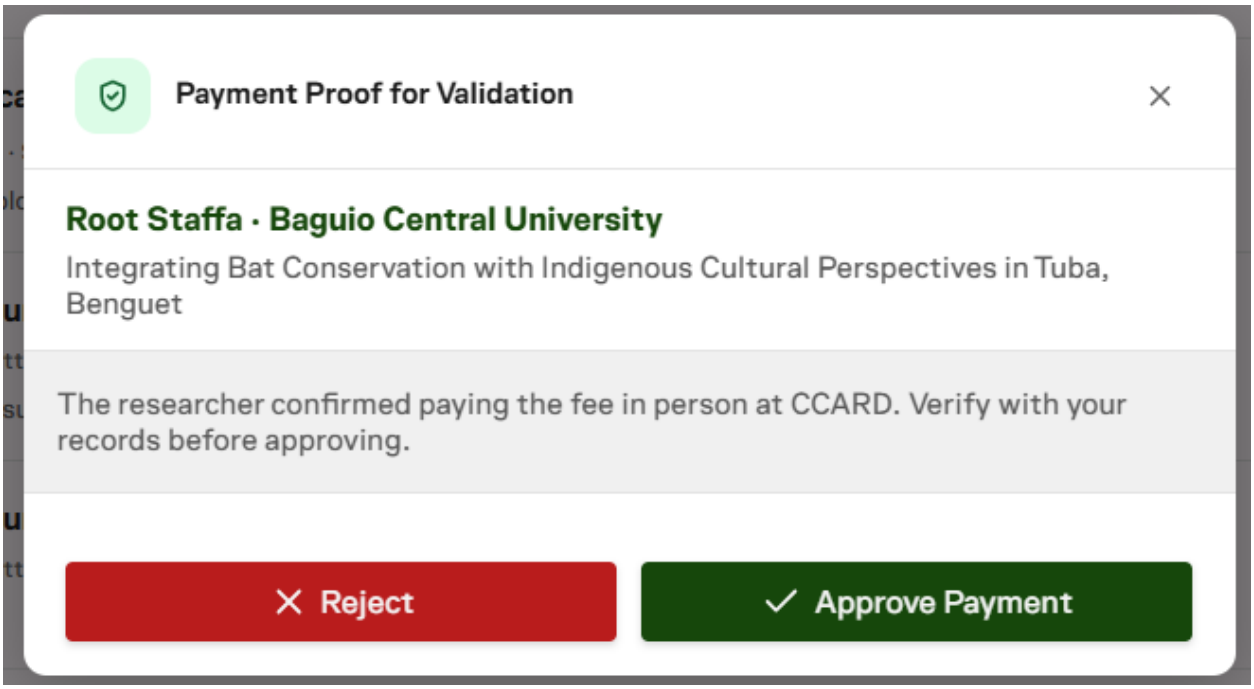
1. The researcher pays the clearance fee and submits their proof. You can do nothing until then.
2. Verify the submitted payment proof.
3. Assign an IPN.
4. Print the protocol for the IACUC chairperson's signature, then upload the signed scan.
5. Mark the protocol as endorsed.

Verifying a payment

When a researcher submits proof of payment, you are notified and the card shows Verify Payment. Press it to open the proof, together with the researcher and protocol title.

1. Check that the proof is readable and matches the clearance fee.
2. To accept it, press Mark as Paid and confirm.
3. To refuse it, choose to reject the proof, type the reason (required), and confirm with Reject Proof.

The researcher is notified either way. A rejected payment shows on the card as Payment Rejected, and the researcher can submit new proof. Researchers from the BSU La Trinidad Campus and the BSU Secondary Laboratory School pay in person, so check their payment against your office records.



Assigning an IPN

Once the payment is paid, the card shows Assign IPN. The IPN has 6 digits, and the last 2 digits are the year, for example 000026. Every IPN must be unique. You can only assign it while the protocol is Reviewed and the payment is verified. Press Edit IPN in the card menu to correct it later.

Uploading the signed scan

Print the protocol, have it signed by the IACUC chairperson, scan it, and press Upload Signed Scan. Only PDF files up to 10 MB are accepted. The IPN has to be assigned first. If the researcher revises the protocol after you upload a scan, you need to upload a new signed scan before endorsing.

Marking as endorsed

When payment is verified, the IPN is assigned and the signed scan is uploaded, press Mark as Endorsed. A confirmation reminds you to double-check the payment and the scan. The portal refuses to endorse until all three are in place.

Endorsing or downloading several at once

On the Reviewed tab, press Select to show a checkbox on each card. Tick the protocols you want, or press Select All for everything that matches the current filter. The bar then offers two buttons.

- Download Selected saves the protocol files as a ZIP.
- Mark Selected as Endorsed endorses all the ticked protocols at once. Each one must meet the same requirements as a single endorsement.

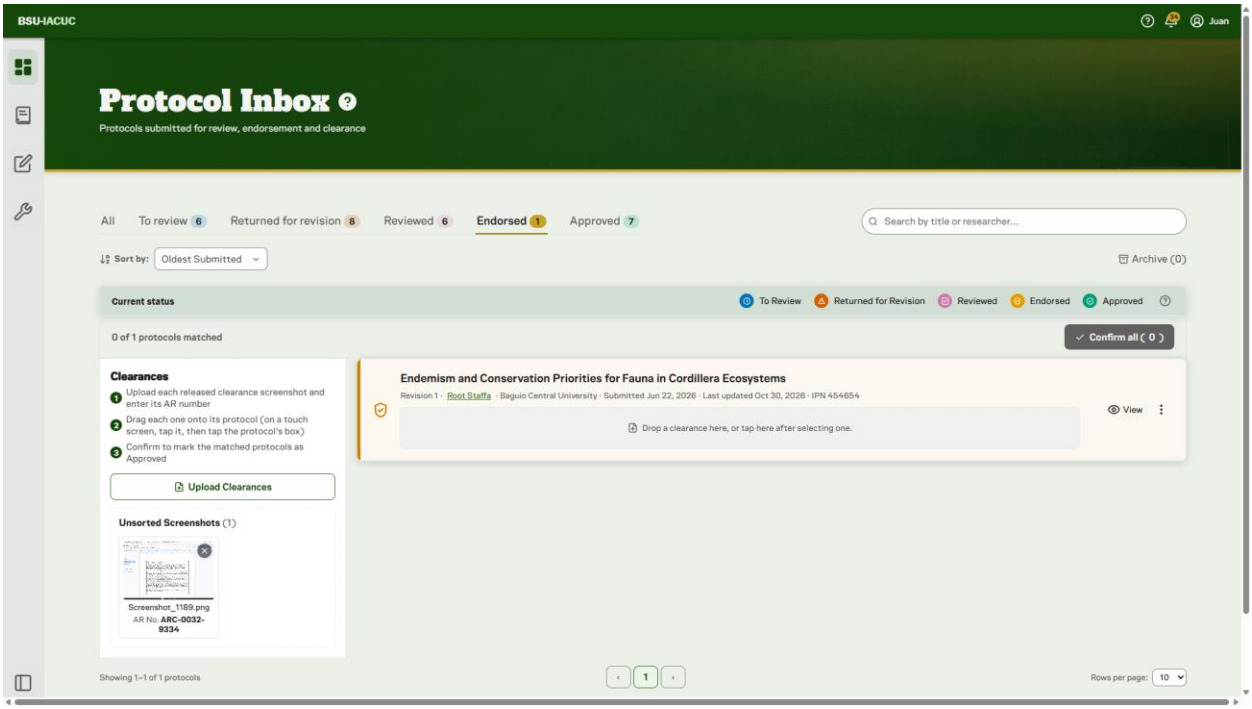
Undoing a step

If you made a mistake, the card menu has an undo for the step you took, as long as the next step has not happened.

Item	*What it does*
Undo "Mark as Paid"	Marks the payment as unpaid again. The researcher is told that CCARD will verify the payment again
Undo Endorsed	Sends an endorsed protocol back to Reviewed
Undo Approved	Sends an approved protocol back to Endorsed. It is not available after the hard copy pickup is confirmed
Undo Pickup	Clears the hard copy pickup date

IX. Matching clearances and approving

After you endorse a protocol, the Department of Agriculture releases the animal research clearance through the BAI. Open the Endorsed tab to see the Clearances panel, where you match each released clearance to its protocol.



Uploading clearances

1. Press Upload Clearances and choose the clearance screenshots. They must be JPG or PNG, and you can choose several at once.
2. Each screenshot is previewed in turn. Enter its AR number, which comes from the BAI clearance, and save. The AR number is required and must be unique.

Uploaded screenshots wait in the Unsorted Screenshots tray. Press the trash icon on a screenshot to delete it.

Matching a clearance to a protocol

Drag each screenshot from the tray onto its protocol. On a touch screen, tap the screenshot, then tap the protocol's box. A progress line shows how many protocols are matched. To undo a match, press the remove icon on the matched screenshot, and it goes back to the tray.

Confirming

Press Confirm on a single match, or Confirm all to approve every matched protocol. A window warns you to double-check the AR number and the clearance file first. After you proceed, each matched protocol becomes Approved and the researcher can download the clearance.

You can also attach a clearance to a protocol and then press Mark as Approved on its card. The portal does not allow approval without an attached clearance.

If the agency returns a protocol

If DA-RFO-CAR or the BAI sends an endorsed protocol back, open its card menu and choose Mark as returned by DA-RFO-CAR or BAI. A reason is required, because the researcher sees it and uses it to revise. The protocol moves to Returned for Revision, and the researcher resubmits it through the usual steps.

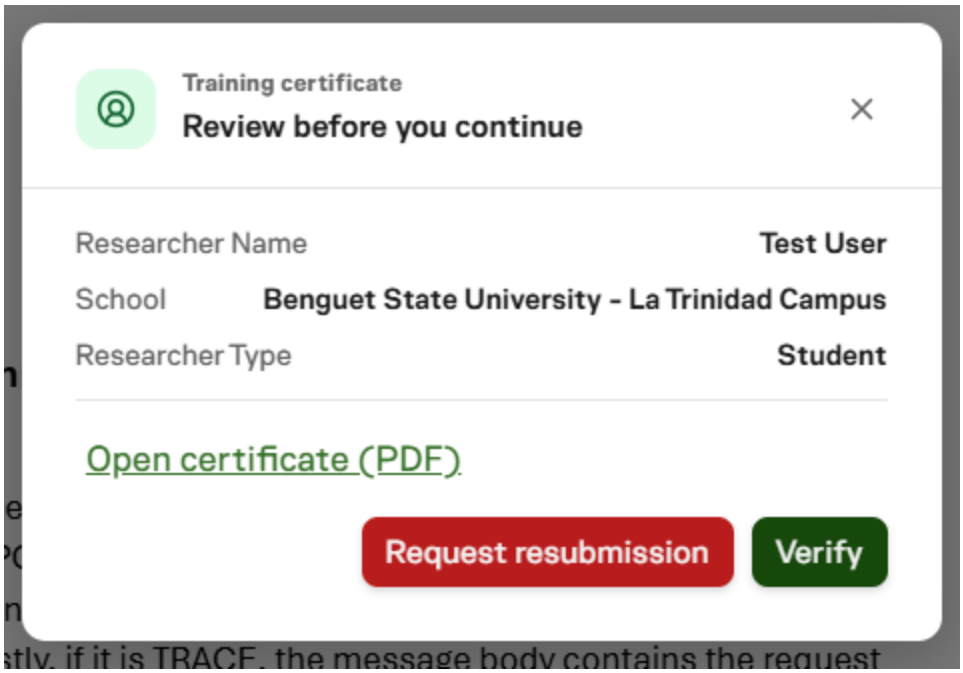
Confirming the hard copy pickup

On an Approved card, press View Clearance to see the soft copy. When the researcher has collected the embossed hard copy at CCARD, press Confirm Pickup. The date is recorded on the researcher's card. If you confirmed it by mistake, press Undo Pickup.

X. Certificates, renaming and deletion

Verifying a training certificate

A researcher's first submission comes with their IACUC training certificate, and a reviewer cannot finish the review until it is verified. Any reviewer or administrative staff member can verify it, and whoever decides first settles it for everyone. Open a protocol with a pending certificate, or press the researcher's name on a card, to see the certificate.



1. Check that the certificate is readable, complete and current, and that the name matches the researcher.
2. To accept it, press Verify and confirm.
3. To refuse it, press Request resubmission, type the reason (required, up to 500 characters), and press Send request.

The researcher is notified of your decision. After a resubmission request, reviewers can still read and comment, but they cannot finish the review until a new certificate is verified.

Reviewing a deletion request

A researcher cannot delete a protocol on their own. They send a request, and you are notified. Open the protocol and press Deletion Requested: Review at the top of the viewer.

- Approve Deletion Request deletes the protocol and notifies the researcher. This cannot be undone.
- Reject Request keeps the protocol. You must type a reason, and the researcher is notified with your explanation.

A protocol that has already been endorsed or approved cannot be deleted.

Renaming and deleting a protocol

Staff can rename a protocol that is To Review or Returned for Revision, and delete one that is To Review, Returned for Revision or Reviewed, with no approval needed. A confirmation asks first. Titles must be unique, and the researcher is notified of a new title.

XI. The three-dot menu

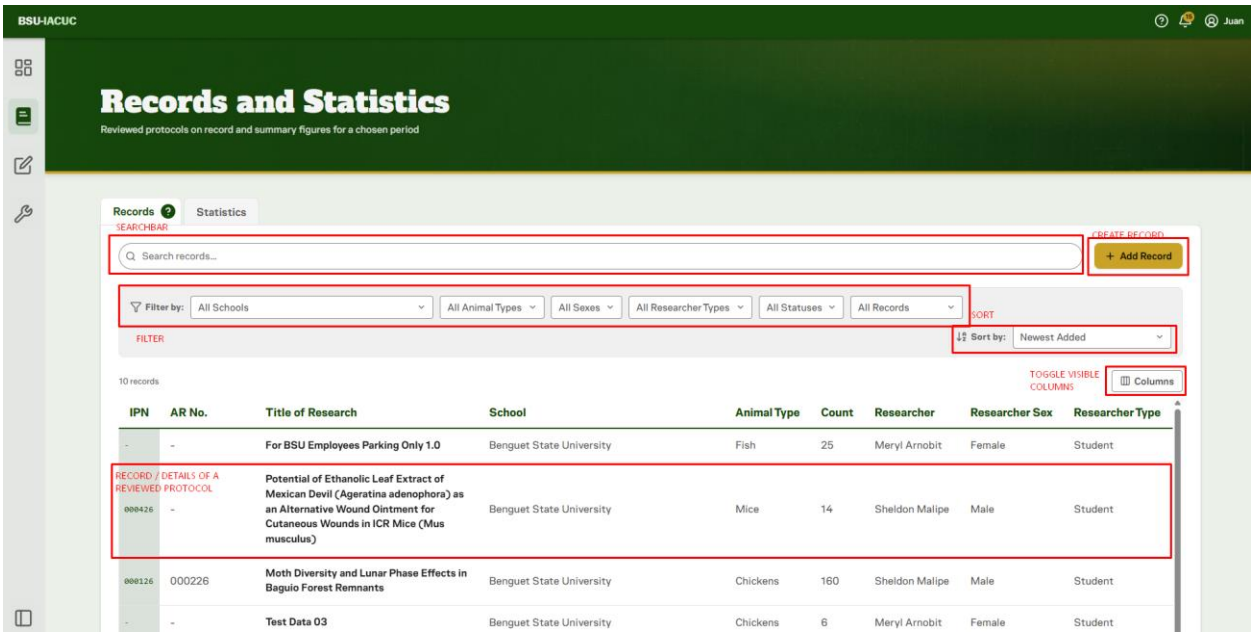
The three-dot button on each card, and the More button inside the viewer, open a menu. Only the items that apply to the protocol appear.

Item	*When it is available*	*What it does*
History	Always	Shows every submitted version, payment records and earlier titles
Download	When a file is on record	Downloads the latest file
Rename	To Review and Returned for Revision	Changes the protocol title
Amendments	After the researcher has submitted one	Lists the amendments
Delete	To Review, Returned for Revision and Reviewed	Deletes the protocol
Edit IPN	Reviewed, after an IPN is assigned	Corrects the IPN
Undo Reviewed	Reviewed, until payment is verified	Sends the protocol back to To Review and removes its record
Undo steps	See section VIII	Reverses payment, endorsement, approval or pickup

Amendments are changes a researcher sends after their clearance was issued. They are not reviewed again, so you only need to read them.

XII. Records and statistics

Records lists every protocol record. A record is added automatically when a reviewer marks a protocol as Reviewed, and removed again if that review is undone.



- Search finds records by what you type.
- Filters narrow the table by school, animal type, sex, researcher type, status, or Needs Completion, which shows records with missing details. Sort changes the order, and so does pressing a column heading. A third press on the same heading resets the order.
- Columns lets you hide the columns you do not use. Your choice is remembered on this computer, and Show all columns brings them back.
- The eye icon on a row opens all the details of that record, including a link to the protocol file.

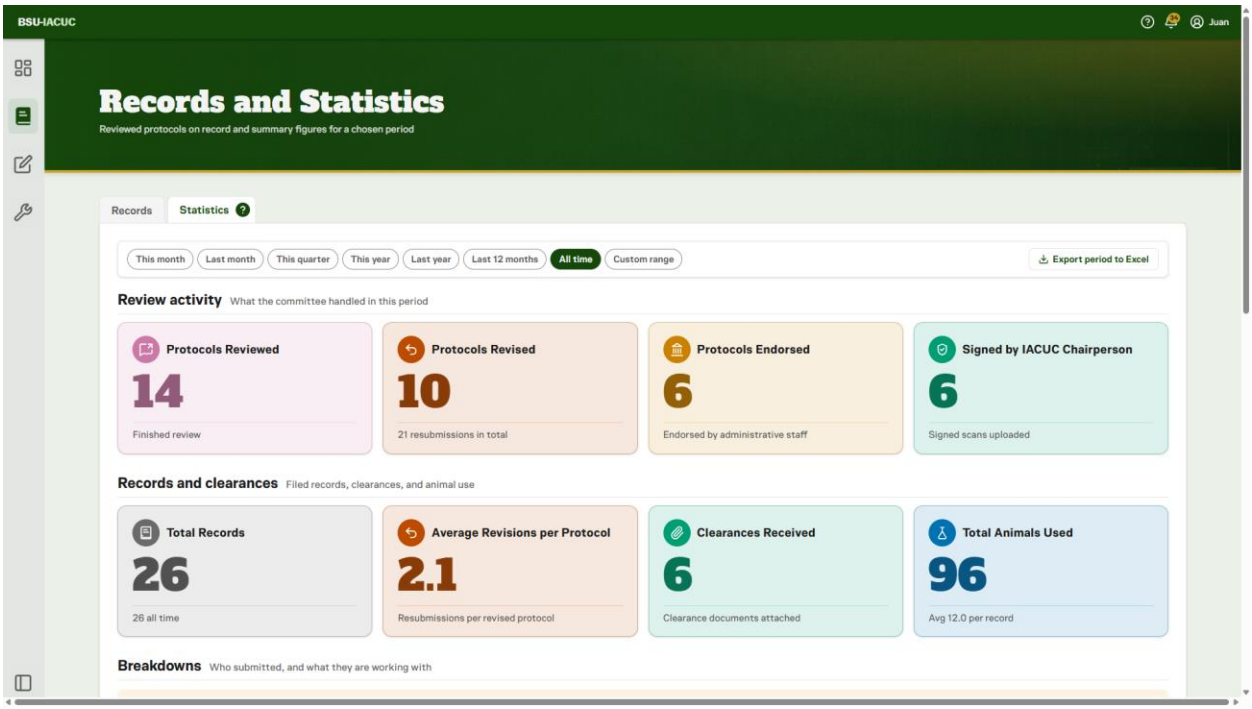
Adding, editing and deleting records

Press Add Record to enter a record by hand, for example for protocols that were cleared before the portal existed. Use the pencil icon on a row to edit it, and the trash icon to delete it, after confirming.

Field	***Notes***
IPN	6 digits, with the last 2 digits as the year, for example 000026
AR No.	From the BAI clearance
Title of Research	The full research title
Researcher	Full name of the principal investigator
School, Animal Type, Animal Count	Pick the school and animal type from the lists. The count is a whole number of 1 or more
Researcher Sex, Researcher Type	Pick from the lists
Research Adviser, Veterinarian	Full names
Research Duration	Start month and end month
Date Released, Status, Received By	The release date, the record status and the name of the receiving officer

Statistics

Open the Statistics tab for totals and charts over a period you choose, including a custom date range. Each card also shows how it compares with the period right before. The cards count protocols reviewed, revised, endorsed and signed, along with records, average revisions, clearances received and animals used. Press Export period to Excel to download the statistics and every record in the period. Search and filters on the Records tab are not applied to the export.



XIII. Site Content

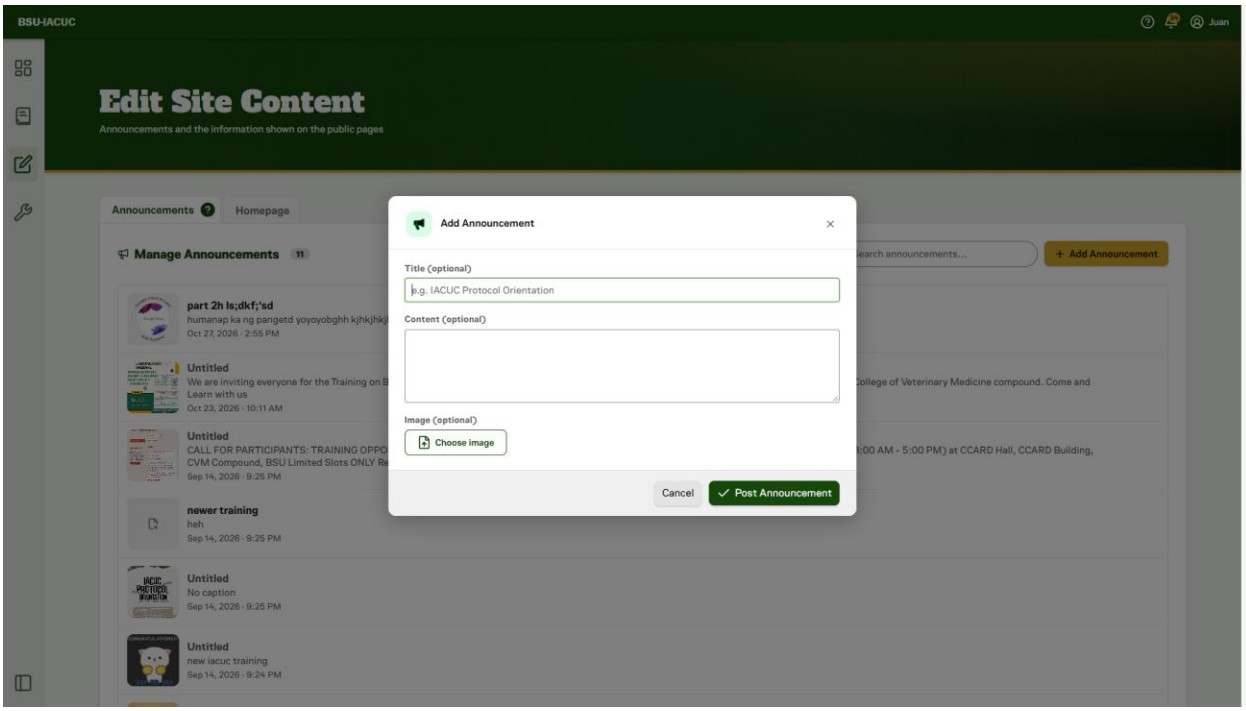
Site Content controls what visitors see on the public pages. It has two tabs, Announcements and Homepage. Changes show on the public site right away.

Announcements

Press Add Announcement to post one. The title, content and image are each optional. Uploaded images are converted automatically so that pages load faster.

1. Press Add Announcement.
2. Type a title and content, and choose an image if you want one.
3. Save it.

Each row shows the photo, title, caption and the date it was posted. Click a row to edit it, or press the photo to see it larger. While editing, you can change the text, replace the photo or remove it. Delete takes the announcement off the public page. Search narrows the list by title or caption.



Homepage banner and text

In Homepage Content, change the banner title and the "What is IACUC?" text. Press Enter to start a new paragraph. To make a link, write it as [link text](https://web-address). Save Changes turns on once you change something. Press it and confirm to apply your edits, or press Discard to undo them.

Contact offices

Press Add Office to add an office card to the public Contact page. Use the arrows on each row to change the order the offices appear in, or edit or delete an office. Clicking a row also opens it for editing.

FAQ

Press Add FAQ to add a question and answer to the FAQ on the public homepage. Use the arrows to change the order, search to find a question or answer, and edit or delete as needed.

XIV. Administration

Administration has three tabs: Audit Logs, Manage Accounts and Backups.

Approving personnel

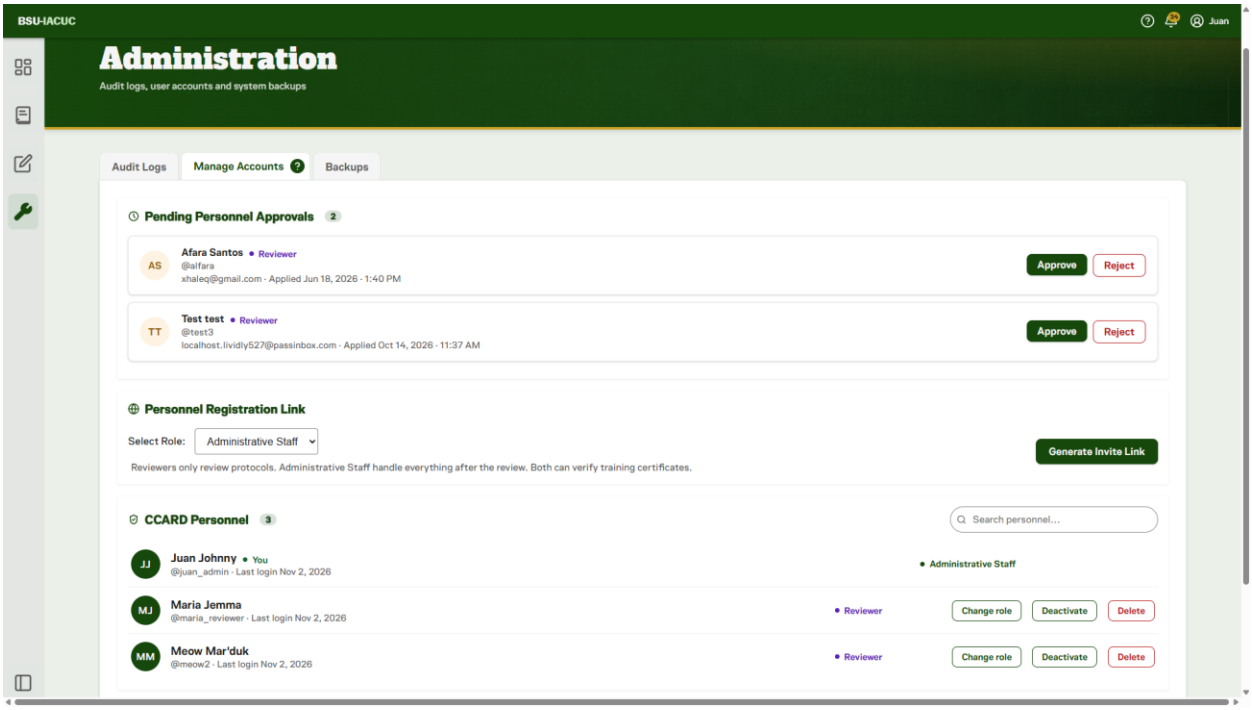
New personnel applications wait under Pending approvals, and you are notified when one arrives. Check that you know the applicant, then press Approve to give them access, or Reject to delete the application. The applicant is told the result by email.

Inviting new personnel

Choose a role, Staff or Reviewer, and generate a registration link. Copy it and send it to the new person. The link works for 48 hours. Reviewers only review protocols, while administrative staff handle everything after the review. Both can verify training certificates.

Managing personnel

Everyone approved is listed under CCARD Personnel.



- Use the role dropdown to switch someone between Administrative Staff and Reviewer. You must enter your password to confirm, and your own role cannot be changed.
- Press Deactivate to lock a user out of their account, and Reactivate to let them back in. Personnel who have not signed in for 6 months are deactivated automatically, and only administrative staff can reactivate them.
- Press Delete to remove a user's account. You must enter your password to confirm.

Audit logs

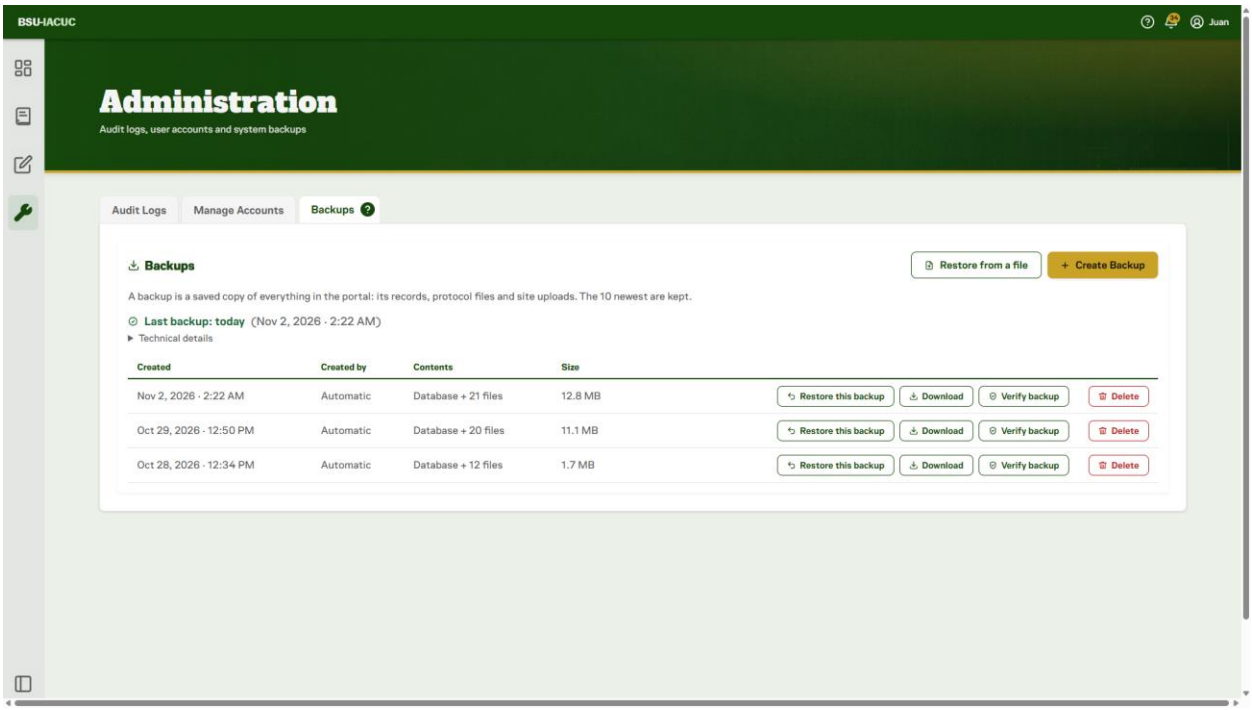
The Audit Logs tab keeps a record of actions taken in the system. Each entry shows when it happened, who did it, the action, what it affected, the details and the IP address, and it also records the old and new status of a protocol.

- Press Refresh to load the latest entries, or pick a date to see only that day. Show all brings every entry back.

- Under Download Audit Logs, choose the dates and export to Excel. The default is the last 90 days. Tick Export full history for everything.

Backups

The Backups tab creates and downloads copies of the database and uploaded files. The page shows when the last backup was made. It turns into a warning when the newest backup is 3 days old or more, or when none exists.



- Press Create Backup. It runs in steps, so keep the page open until the bar reaches 100%.
- Download keeps a backup off the server. Verify backup confirms it is intact without restoring it. Delete removes ones you no longer need. The 10 newest are kept.
- Restore from a file uploads a backup ZIP you saved earlier. It is sent in small pieces and checked before it appears in the list.
- Backups marked Encrypted can only be restored with the BACKUP_PASSPHRASE from your .env file. If you lose it, those backups cannot be opened.

Restore this backup replaces all current data and uploads with the backup, so use it with great care. A safety backup of the current data is saved first. You confirm with your password and by typing RESTORE. If a backup has data that points to missing records, the restore is refused and nothing changes. Use a newer backup instead.

XV. Notifications and email

The bell in the top bar shows a badge when there is something new. Press it to see the latest items, or choose See all notifications for the full list with page controls. Mark all as read clears the badge. Each notification says what happened and what, if anything, you need to do next.

As administrative staff, you are notified when:

- A researcher submits or resubmits a protocol. No action is needed, because a reviewer assesses it first.
- A researcher uploads proof of payment. Open the protocol to verify it.
- A researcher requests deletion of a protocol. Open it to approve or reject the request.
- A training certificate needs to be verified.
- Someone applies as personnel. Open Administration to approve or reject the application.

The portal also sends these updates by email. You can turn email updates on or off from My Account, or from the manage preferences link at the bottom of any email. Turning emails off does not stop in-portal notifications.

If the page shows a message that says new activity was detected, press it to refresh.

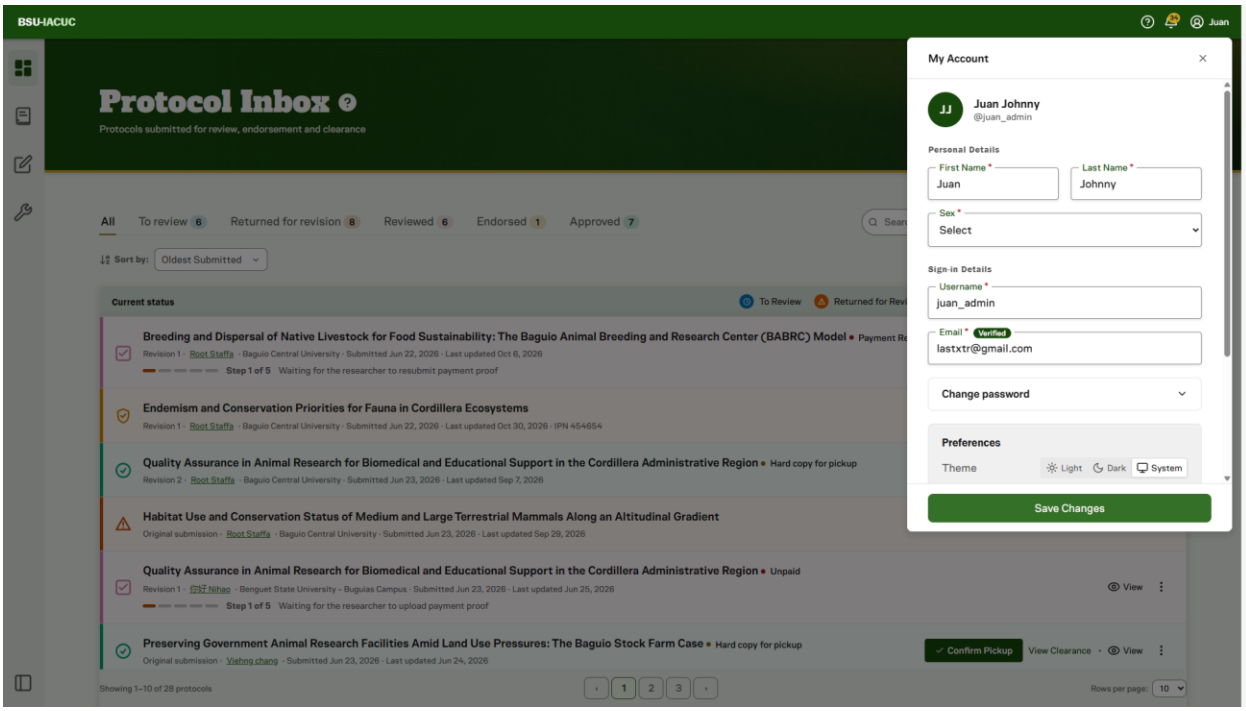
Working with a weak connection

If your connection drops, an Offline tag appears beside the logo. Actions you take while offline are saved on your device and sent automatically when the connection returns. A banner shows what is waiting. Keep the page open until it finishes.

If a protocol changed on the server while you were offline, the banner asks you to choose for each waiting action. Keep mine tries your action again. Keep theirs drops your action and leaves the server as it is. Discard all drops every waiting action.

XVI. My Account

Open My Account from the top bar. Here you can:



- Update your name, username and email.
- Send yourself a new verification link if your email is not verified.
- Change your password.
- Choose light, dark or system theme.
- Turn email notifications on or off.
- Preview the public site.
- Delete your account.

Deleting your account

Press Delete account and enter your password to confirm. Deletion cannot be undone. If you are the only active administrative staff account, you cannot delete it. Give another account the staff role first.

XVII. Troubleshooting

Problem	*What to try*
The invitation link does not work	Invitation links expire after 48 hours. Generate a new one in Administration
Cannot log in, and the portal says approval is pending	Another administrative staff member has to approve your application first
Cannot log in after several tries	Wait 15 minutes, or use Forgot Password
The portal says the account is deactivated	Ask another administrative staff member to reactivate it in Administration

Cannot assign an IPN	The payment must be verified first, and the IPN must be 6 digits and not used by another protocol
Cannot upload the signed scan	The payment must be verified and an IPN assigned first. Only PDF files up to 10 MB are accepted
Cannot mark as endorsed	Payment must be verified, an IPN assigned and a current signed scan uploaded
Cannot mark as approved	A clearance has to be attached to the protocol. Match it in the Clearances panel
The clearance upload is refused	Use JPG or PNG files, enter the AR number, and check that the AR number is not already used
Cannot undo a step	Undo the later step first, for example the pickup before the approval, or the payment before the review
Cannot delete a protocol	Endorsed and approved protocols cannot be deleted
Signed out unexpectedly	The portal signs out after 30 minutes without activity. Log in again

XVIII. Getting help

For questions about the IACUC, protocols or clearances, email ccard@bsu.edu.ph or use the Contact Us page, which lists every office, with address, phone, email and website. For problems with the portal itself, the Home page FAQ lists who to contact.

XIX. Glossary

Term	*Meaning*
IACUC	Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee. Reviews research that uses live animals
CCARD	Cordillera Center for Animal Research and Development, Benguet State University
Protocol	The written plan for a researcher's animal work, on the official IACUC form
Reviewer	CCARD personnel who comment on protocols and mark them as reviewed or return them for revision
Administrative staff	CCARD personnel who handle every step after the review, and who manage accounts and site content
IPN	The 6-digit reference number you assign to a protocol before it is endorsed
AR No.	The animal research clearance number printed on the BAI clearance
Signed scan	The scan of the protocol signed by the IACUC chairperson
Endorsed	Sent to the Department of Agriculture, Regional Field Office, for the clearance
Animal research clearance	The document issued through the BAI that allows a researcher's animal work to start
BAI	Bureau of Animal Industry

DA-RFO-CAR	Department of Agriculture, Regional Field Office, Cordillera Administrative Region
Amendment	A change to a protocol after its clearance was issued